Start Here: Your Monochrome Darkroom Wedding Website

Thank you for choosing BKE Studio. This guide takes you from this PDF to a live wedding website that your guests open on their phones. Keep this file: it is the only one you need.

Good to know before you begin

• You do not need Canva, an app or an account. Everything works in the web browser of your phone or computer.

• Your Etsy order number and your email address are your way in: they open your editor on any phone or computer. There is no password.

• You fill in your website yourself, in a simple editor. Every change saves by itself.

• Nobody sees your website until you publish it, and you can keep changing it after you publish.

• Your guests need no app and no account either: they open your link and tap the envelope.

Start now: the first 5 steps

1. Open your start link: Start your Monochrome Darkroom website. Or scan this QR code with your phone camera.

Link and QR code not working? Type this address into your browser:
https://bkestudio.com/start?theme=monochrome-darkroom

2. Find your Etsy order number: on Etsy, go to You → Purchases and reviews, or look for "Order #…" in your Etsy confirmation email.

3. Enter your Etsy order number, your email address and your first names. Check the website address, then tap **Create my website**.

4. Tap **Copy link** to keep your private edit link as a shortcut, then tap **Open my editor**. Add your first names and your wedding date (setup step 1 of 3).

5. Add one photo (step 2 of 3). Publish now (step 3 of 3), or later when everything is ready.

Come back on any device

There is no account and no password. Your Etsy order number and the email address you entered on the start page open your editor again, on this phone or on any other phone or computer:

> **Continue on another device**
>
> 1. Open https://bkestudio.com/my, or tap **Create your website** on our website.
> 2. Under **Open or start your website**, enter the same **Etsy order number** and **Email address**, then tap **Continue**.
> 3. Your editor opens where you left off: every change is saved online.

Your private edit link is a shortcut to the same editor. Tap **Copy link** and paste it into your notes app, or tap **Email it to myself** (your own email app opens with the link inside; tap Send). Once your editor is open, you can also add it to your phone's Home Screen. Copy the link again any time under **Share** → **Your private edit link** → **Copy edit link**.

In your editor, **Share** → **Use on another device** shows this address with a QR code to scan with your other phone, the devices signed in with your order number, and **Sign out other devices**.

Anyone who has your edit link, or your order number together with your email, can change your website: share them only with your partner. We will never ask you for your edit link.

Step 1. Start your website

Open the start link. At the top you see a small live demo of your design (**Open the full demo** shows it full size). Below it, fill in **Your details**:

• **Etsy order number:** on Etsy under You → Purchases and reviews, or "Order #…" in your Etsy confirmation email. It has 8 to 12 digits. You can type it with or without "#".

• **Email address:** we keep it with your website. Together with your order number it opens your editor on any phone or computer, so use one you will remember.

• **Your first names:** as your guests know you. You can change them later in the editor.

• **Website address:** made from your names, for example …/avery-and-jordan. "Available" means it is free. You can change it here, but **not later**, so check the spelling.

Tap **Create my website**. One order starts one website. Your website starts as a private draft: nobody can see it until you publish.

If your connection drops, tap **Create my website** again: you get your link back. If your order already has a website and you enter the email you started with, the page opens it for you. With another email it says "This order already has a website": see Troubleshooting.

Step 2. Set up in three steps

The editor starts with a short setup. The bar at the top shows **Step 1 of 3**. On steps 1 and 2, **Skip for now** sits next to **Continue**; **Save & exit** works at any time. Everything is saved.

1. **Your names and date.** Your two first names, then the wedding date and the ceremony time. The **Time zone of the wedding** comes from your phone; tap **Change** if the wedding is in another time zone. **Full names for the invitation card** are optional. One line says how often you can change your names or date after you publish; **Learn more** explains what is always free.

2. **Add your photo.** One photo is enough to start: it opens your website. The editor tells you how many more photo places your design has; add them any time under **Edit** → **Photos**. Until then guests see a soft placeholder image.

3. **Publish your website.** Check the summary and the preview, read **Good to know before you publish**, then tap **Publish my website**. Or come back later: Home shows how ready your website is.

How your names appear, the monogram (if your design shows one) and the date style (Month first or Day first) are not part of the setup: you find them later under **Edit**.

If your date is still the design's sample date, the editor asks you to set your real date first.

When your website is live, **Your website is live** shows your link with **Copy link**, **Open website** and, on a phone, **Share**. The QR code for printed cards is under **More ways to share**. **Next, if you like** suggests a few optional next steps, and **Go to my editor** takes you to Home.

If your editor says "We are confirming your Etsy order"

Your order has to be confirmed in our Etsy shop before your website can go live. You can set up everything now; it is all saved. **Publish** opens as soon as your order is confirmed, usually within 24 hours. Reload your editor page to check. If it takes longer, message us on Etsy with your order number.

Step 3. Edit your website

Use the buttons at the bottom of the screen (at the top on a computer):

• **Home:** your website's status and link, how ready it is, the next things to do, new replies and your dates (Wedding, Replies close, Online until). Under **Settings** you see your time zone, date style, name and date changes left and guest password; tap a row to change it.

• **Edit:** six pages with everything on your website.

• **Guests:** your guests' replies.

• **Share:** your link, QR code, guest password, downloads (your website as a PDF and a printable invitation), your private edit link and how to open your editor on another device.

Edit page	What you change
Us	First names, full names for the invitation card, how your names appear, monogram (if your design shows one), the languages of your website
Day & place	Date and ceremony time (time zone, date style and countdown under More options); venue, address, map link, map and directions, a reception place and venue photo; the order of the day (up to 10 rows); After the wedding
Photos	Invitation portrait, three story photos and the venue photo
Our Story	Show or hide the page, an intro line, a caption for each story moment, music and sound effects
Details	Host line, dress code, travel & stay and registry links, guest policy note (in some designs), up to 12 questions and answers
RSVP	Replies on or off, reply-by date, the reply form: which fields are required and up to 10 questions of your own

Your own wording. At the end of every Edit page, open **Headings & labels on this page**. There you can rewrite the design's texts in your own words, for example "You are invited", "Will You Join Us?" or the menu. Leave a box empty to keep the design's text; **Reset to design text** brings it back. On **Us** you can also pick suggested wording for a vow renewal, an elopement party or a commitment ceremony. Wording changes never use a name or date change.

What stays as designed: the artwork, colors, fonts, page layout and the envelope animation.

Sample text. Boxes that still hold the design's sample text look faded (in italics, with a dashed border), and the top of the page says how many are left, for example "3 fields still show sample text". Tap **Go to the first one** and type your own text before you share your website. Home lists what is left.

Saving. There is no Save button: every change saves as you type. **Saved** shows for a moment at the top, then a small cloud icon stays. If you are offline, your changes are kept on this phone and saved when you are back online; wait until it says saved before you close the page. If the editor says your website was changed on another device, reload the page to get the latest version.

Step 4. Add and crop photos

Open **Edit** → **Photos**, choose a frame and tap **Add photo**. Drag to move the photo, zoom with the slider or two fingers, then tap **Use this photo**. Each frame has its own shape. You can replace or remove a photo any time.

JPG, PNG, WebP, AVIF and HEIC photos up to 30 MB work. If a photo will not open, save a JPEG copy of it and choose that.

No photos yet? Your website still works: empty frames show the design's soft placeholder image, and you can hide the Our Story page. Add your own photos before you share if you do not want guests to see placeholders.

Map and directions

Open **Edit** → **Day & place** → **Venue**. Type the street address, or paste a Google Maps or Apple Maps link to the place into **Map link**. Below it, **Map & directions** has two switches:

• **Show map:** guests see a card with the place and tap **Show map** to load Google Maps. Nothing loads from Google before that tap.

• **Show directions:** guests get directions with Google Maps, Apple Maps or Waze.

The editor shows what guests' maps will find (the pin of your link, or your address); tap **Preview map** to check it. Is the reception somewhere else? Tap **Add a reception place** and add its name, address and map link: guests then see both places. **Remove this place** takes it away again.

Music and sound

Open **Edit** → **Our Story** and scroll to **Music & sound** at the end of the page.

• **Story music:** choose one of four tracks made for your website (**First Light**, **Garden Waltz**, **Evening Strings**, **Music Box**; one is marked as suggested for your design), **Your own music** or **No music**. Tap **Listen** to hear it.

• **Your own music:** tap **Choose a file** and upload an MP3 or M4A file of up to 10 MB. Only upload music you have the right to use (your own recording or a licence that allows it).

• **Sound effects:** soft sounds when guests open the envelope, move between pages and send their reply. Turn it off for a quiet website.

Guests hear the music softly on your Our Story page (no Our Story page, no music). A small sound button at the top left of every page turns the sound off or on. Some phones wait for a tap before music starts: then guests see a "Play music" button.

Languages

Your website can be in English, Spanish, French, German or Turkish, or in several of them. Open **Edit** → **Us** → **Languages**:

• **Main language:** the language you write your texts in. Guests see it first.

• **Also show my website in:** tick the other languages. Guests then get a small language button on every page.

• The design's headings, buttons, reply form and dates come translated for you.

• Your own texts (story, details, questions and answers, your own headings) are listed under each language. **Translate automatically** makes a first draft: with your browser's own translator if it has one, otherwise with the free MyMemory translation service (your texts are sent to it). Read each translation and correct it if needed, then tap **Approve** or **Approve all**. Guests see a translation only after you approve it; until then they see your main language.

• **Language of this editor** changes the language of the editor itself.

Machine translation is only a first draft: if you can, ask someone who speaks the language to read it.

Step 5. Preview and publish

Tap the eye icon at the top to preview your pages: **Envelope**, **Home**, **Story**, **Details** and **RSVP**. **Envelope** is the opening page, where guests tap the envelope. The X at the top closes the preview. On a computer the preview stays on the right.

First publish: tap **Publish**. **Before you publish** lists anything guests would still see from the design (sample text, photo places without a photo, sections without a link). Tap an item to fix it, or tap **Publish my website** and fix it later. Then **Your website is live** shows your link with **Copy link**, **Open website** and, on a phone, **Share**; the QR code is under **More ways to share**. You find both again under **Share** at any time.

After that: your changes save to a draft, and guests see the last version you published. When you change something, a bar shows **Unpublished changes**. Tap **Review** to see which pages changed (the eye next to a page previews it), then **Publish changes** (or tap **Publish** in the bar).

Name and date changes after publishing

Before your first publish you can change everything freely. After it:

• You have **3 changes in total** for your names, monogram and wedding date. Changing several at once counts as one.

• Always free: fixing a small typo (up to 2 letters in a name), adding a surname, and moving your date by up to 7 days.

• Changed something by mistake? Undo it right away (before you publish it, or within 10 minutes) and you get the change back.

• Everything else (time, venue, schedule, story, photos, details, wording and replies) you can change as often as you like.

Your names and date show with a **Change** button and the changes you have left on the **Us** and **Day & place** pages. The editor tells you before you confirm whether a change is free. If your wedding moves and you have no changes left, message us on Etsy with your order number.

Step 6. Share your website

Open **Share**:

• **Your website link: Copy** it and send it by text, WhatsApp or email, or tap **Open** to see it as a guest. Most messaging apps show a preview card with your names and date; send it to yourself first to check.

• **QR code for printed cards** (shown once your website is live): tap it to open, then **Download PNG** or **Download SVG**. Scan it once with your phone camera before you print.

• Your website is not listed on Google. Only people with your link or QR code can open it.

Guest password (optional). Open **Guest password** and turn on **Password protect your website**. Type a password of 4 to 40 characters (capital letters do not matter) or tap **Suggest a password**, then **Turn on password**. Use **Copy password** to send it with your link. It is one shared password for all guests, not a login for each person. Guests type it once; their browser remembers it. If you change it, guests are asked for the new one. Turned off, anyone with the link can open your website.

Downloads (in **Share**):

• **Download website as PDF:** every page of your website in your design, with a QR code to your link on the last page.

• **Printable invitation:** a classic invitation card in your design, with your names, date and venue. Choose **5 × 7 in** or **A5 (148 × 210 mm)**. **Add a back side with the details and a QR code** is ticked at first. For a print shop, tick **For a print shop: add bleed (1/8 in / 3 mm)** and then **Add crop marks**. Tap **Download printable invitation**.

Both use your latest saved changes, and making a PDF can take up to a minute. Publish your website first: the QR code opens it only once it is live. Print one copy and scan its QR code with your phone before you print them all.

Take the website offline (at the bottom of Share) hides your website from guests: they see "Page not found" until you publish again. Your text, photos and replies are kept.

Step 7. Guest replies

What guests do: on your RSVP page they enter their name, whether they are coming, how many people (up to 10 in one reply), the names of the others (optional), a message and your questions. They need no account, and an email address is optional unless you make it required. To change their answer, they send another reply.

Reply form. In **Edit** → **RSVP**, the reply form shows what guests fill in. Their name and whether they are coming are **Always required**. Email and the message can be **Required** or **Optional**. Under **Your questions**, tap **Add a question** (up to 10, for example a meal choice) and pick the answer type: **Choices**, **Yes / No**, **Short answer**, **Long answer** or **Number**. Each question can be required or optional too. Guests who are coming answer your questions. Changing or removing a question later keeps the answers you already have.

What you do: open **Guests** (not Edit → RSVP, which changes the form). It has two views:

• **Guest list:** how many guests are coming and not coming, then every reply. Search by name, or tap **All**, **Coming**, **Not coming** or **New** to filter. Tap a reply to see everyone in it, their answers and their message.

• **Results:** how many replies say coming and not coming, and the answers to your questions, each with a number and a percentage. Tap a line to see who is in it.

In the Guest list you can also:

• **Download Excel** (at the bottom of the screen) to save every reply and a summary in one Excel file. It opens in Excel, Numbers and Google Sheets too. **Download CSV** saves a plain list, one row per person.

• **Add a reply** you got by phone or in person. On each reply, **Edit reply** corrects it and **Remove reply** deletes it.

• **Print list**, or save it as a PDF from your browser's print menu.

• **Refresh** to load new replies.

Google Sheets (optional): in **Guests**, tap **Connect Google Sheets** and allow access in Google. Your editor makes a spreadsheet in your own Google Drive and adds every new reply by itself; the columns follow your reply form. Google lets it see only the files it makes, nothing else in your Drive. **Open sheet** opens it, **Sync now** updates it at once, and **Disconnect** stops it (the spreadsheet stays in your Drive). If you see "Google Sheets: coming soon", this connection is not switched on yet: use **Download Excel** instead.

New replies show on Home and under **New**, where **Mark as seen** clears them. If **Guests** offers **Email me when a guest replies**, you can turn it on to get a short email for each new reply. Replies that arrive in an unusual rush go to **Held**: they are not counted until you tap **Keep this reply**.

Replies close at the end of your reply-by date, in your wedding's time zone. To close earlier, turn off **Accept replies on the website** in Edit → RSVP.

Step 8. After the wedding

Open **Edit** → **Day & place** → **After the wedding** and choose a **Thank-you mode**:

• **Automatic:** your website becomes a thank-you page at midnight after your wedding day (wedding time zone).

• **On now:** it shows right after you publish.

• **Off:** keeps the invitation.

Add a title, a message and a photo if you like, preview it and publish. In thank-you mode, replies close and the countdown and calendar buttons disappear. Your replies stay in **Guests**. Under **The Day page**, choose **Keep it** (schedule and venue as a keepsake) or **Hide it**.

How long your website stays online

Your website stays online until **12 months after your wedding date**. Home → Dates → **Online until** shows the exact day, and Home reminds you 30 days before. After that it closes for guests; in your editor you can still see your content and download your replies. Need it online longer? Message us on Etsy before your **Online until** date and we can extend it. 12 months after your website closes, we delete it with its photos and replies, so download your replies before then.

Quick answers

Can my partner edit too? Yes. Give your partner your order number and email, or your edit link, and nobody else.

Can I use a computer, or more than one phone? Yes. On each one, open https://bkestudio.com/my and enter your order number and email. On a computer the preview stays beside the editor.

Can I change the website address? No, it is fixed when you create your website. Your own domain (yournames.com) is not included.

Can I change colors or fonts? No. You change the content and the wording; the design stays as made.

Can it be in my language? Yes, in English, Spanish, French, German or Turkish, or in several of them (see Languages above). Your own texts can be in any language; the design's built-in texts come in one of these five. Accented Latin letters use the design's fonts; Cyrillic and other alphabets show in a plain standard font in some or all places. Preview every page.

How many guests can I invite? As many as you like. One reply can include up to 10 people.

Can guests see each other's replies? No. Only you see them, in your private editor.

Can I start a second website with my order? No. One order starts one website.

Is there music? Yes, if you like: soft music on your Our Story page (see Music and sound above). Choose **No music** to turn it off.

Can I print invitations? Is there a save the date? You print them yourself: **Share** → **Downloads** makes a printable invitation in your design (5 × 7 in or A5, with an optional back side, bleed and crop marks). We do not print or ship anything, and there is no separate save the date.

Troubleshooting

Guests cannot see my changes. Tap **Review**, then **Publish changes**. Then reload your website.

The Publish button does not work. Check your internet connection. Then read the message near the button: your order may still be being confirmed, your date may still be the sample date, or a field needs fixing (the editor shows which one).

"This edit link no longer works." A new link may have replaced it, or only part of the link was copied. Tap **Continue with your order number** and enter your Etsy order number and email: your editor opens again.

"This order already has a website." Open https://bkestudio.com/my and enter your order number with the email you used when you started (your partner's, if they started it).

My order number and email do not open my editor. Check both: use the email you entered on the start page. Still stuck? Message us on Etsy with your order number.

My photo will not upload. Try a JPEG copy of the photo, and check your connection.

The editor says I am offline or changes are not saved. Wait until your connection is back and it says saved before you close the page.

A guest cannot open my website. Check that Home says your website is live, that the link is complete, and whether the guest password is on.

The QR code does not scan. Download it again from Share and print it larger, with white space around it. Always scan a printed proof before printing all cards.

Guests hear no music. Some phones wait for a tap: guests tap "Play music". Check that your Our Story page is shown and a track is chosen under **Music & sound**.

Google Sheets says "Sync failed". Tap **Sync now**. If it shows **Connect again**, tap it and allow access in Google again.

The countdown or calendar time is wrong. Check **Time zone of the wedding** in Edit → Day & place → **More options** (or tap **Time zone** under **Settings** on Home).

Help and privacy

In your editor, **Help & questions** at the bottom of Home answers the most common questions.

Message BKE Studio on Etsy (in the conversation of your order), or write to **bkestudio@gmail.com**. We reply within **24 hours**. Please include your order number, your website address, what you see (a screenshot helps) and your phone and browser. Never send your edit link: we never need it.

Prefer us to do it? Send us your details on Etsy and we enter them for you, as a separate Etsy purchase.

Your guests' replies are visible only in your private editor, not on your website. To have your website, its photos and your guests' replies deleted sooner, message us on Etsy with your order number: we delete them within 30 days. Privacy notice: https://bkestudio.com/privacy.

The design's sample names, dates, places and photos are fictional. Replace them before you share your website.